Listing 5.30 Replacing the content of a document

```
PUT movies/_doc/1
{
  "title":"Avatar"
}
```

The existing movie, *The Godfather*, is replaced with the new data attributes (*Avatar*) after we execute this command.

> **NOTE** If our intent is to replace existing content with something else, we use the `_doc` API on the same ID with a new request body. However, if we do not wish to replace the document, we must use the `_create` endpoint (discussed in section 5.1.1).

Sometimes, when we try to update a nonexistent document, we want Elasticsearch to index it as a new document rather than throw an error. This is what the *upsert* operation is all about.

5.4.5 Upserts

Upsert, short for update and insert, is an operation that either updates a document (if it exists) or indexes a new document with the data provided (if it does not exist). Figure 5.14 demonstrates this operation.

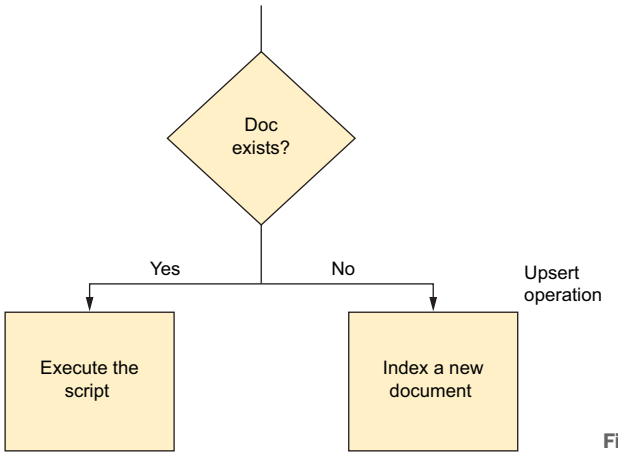


Figure 5.14 Upsert operation workflow

Let's say we want to update `gross_earnings` for the movie *Top Gun*. Remember, we don't have this movie in our store yet. We can develop a query to update the `gross_earnings` field and create a new document with this update.